UNIT 11

Election and Representation



11.1 Meaning and nature of Franchise and Representation

What is Franchise and Election?

The right to vote in public elections. The word "Franchise" is of Anglo-French derivation-from Franc, meaning FREE. An election is the process of voting to choose someone to be their political leader or representative in government.

DO YOU KNOW? Part xv, Articles **324-329 deals with Elections**

And what is Representation?

It is nothing but the action of speaking or acting on behalf of someone or the state of being so represented.

Learning Objectives

- To enable the students to understand the meaning of election and representation.
- To explain the term 'Psephology'.
- To enable students to understand the various methods of election.
- To gain awareness about the Election Commission of India.
- To know the importance of Anti-Defection Law.
- To enlighten about the need of free and fair elections.
- To bring out the role of youth in politics.

Part XV of the Indian Constitution titled "Elections" is of great importance. The constitution –makers had been anxious to safeguard this political right as an integral part of the constitution itself. It is for this important reason that the subject of elections has been accorded a constitutional recognition in our country.

DO YOU KNOW? Article 326 of the Indian Constitution says that the elections to the Lok Sabha and to the Vidhan Sabha of every state shall be on the basis of Adult Suffrage.

Although elections were used in Ancient Athens, Rome and in the selection of Popes and Holy Roman Emperors, the origins of elections in the contemporary world was in the gradual emergence of representative government in Europe and North America which began in the 17th century. In a representative democracy elections are extremely important. Voting, in elections is the best way to make your voice heard. One fact that makes elections more important is when political parties try to suppress voting with the use of laws to disallow people to vote. Election and representation is the core for the formation of government.

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